Delivering Change & Client Craft

1. Why change fails

A recommendation only creates value when people change what they do. Most failed transformations had sound strategy and weak adoption.

- No visible, sustained sponsor · the 'why' never explained · too many initiatives at once · incentives and systems still reward the old way · no early wins
- 'Seventy percent of transformations fail' is folklore; the evidence is weak. The point that **adoption is the hard part** is well supported

2. Two change models

- **Kotter's eight steps** (organisation level): create urgency → build a guiding coalition → form a vision → communicate it → remove obstacles → create short-term wins → build on the change → anchor it in the culture
- **ADKAR** (individual level): **A**wareness of the need · **D**esire to take part · **K**nowledge of how · **A**bility to do it · **R**einforcement to make it stick. Use it to find where a group is stuck

✎ DIAGRAM



Adoption stalls at the first missing step; more training only fixes Knowledge.

ADKAR: diagnose where people drop off.

3. Running the programme

- **Steering committee** (decides, removes blockers) · **PMO** (plans, risks, dependencies, benefits) · **workstreams** (each with an owner, plan, milestones, KPIs)
- **RAID log**: Risks, Assumptions, Issues, Dependencies, reviewed weekly
- **RAG status** with honest criteria (an amber that stays amber for months is usually red)

- **Benefits tracking** against the agreed baseline, signed off by finance · **stage gates** with explicit go/no-go criteria
- **Leading indicators** (adoption, compliance, pipeline) warn early; **lagging indicators** (cost, revenue) confirm months later. Track both

> ⚠ **Watermelon reporting**: green on the outside, red on the inside. Escalate early with options, not late with excuses.

4. Client management and trust

- **Trust = (Credibility + Reliability + Intimacy) ÷ Self-orientation** (The Trusted Advisor)
- Agree what 'done' looks like at the start; say yes to the need, then discuss the trade-off for new requests
- Under-promise on timing and deliver early; never surprise the client with a slip
- Deliver **bad news early, in person, with facts and options**: clients forgive bad news, not hiding it
- Protect confidential information, declare conflicts, never shade findings to please a sponsor: **independence is the product**

✎ DIAGRAM

$$\frac{\text{Credibility + Reliability + Intimacy}}{\text{Self-orientation}}$$

Focusing on yourself, your firm or the next sale divides everything above the line.

The trust equation.

SAY IT

"Clients forgive bad news; they don't forgive hiding it. I'd bring it early, in person, with the facts and two options to close the gap."